



Monthly Branch Meeting Agenda, Minutes and Newsletter

Wellsford Library - 10th August 2019, 10:00

Club Contact	Richard Paul	ZL1DP	rentdrive@xtra.co.nz	09 425 7233
President	Gary Ball	ZL1FAB	gary@theballz.co.nz	020 425 9902
Secretary	Ross Boswell	ZL1DRB	zl1rod@med.co.nz	
Treasurer	Paul Sole	ZL1VPS		

Agenda

- Members In Attendance/Apologies/Visitors
- Confirmation/Actions from Previous Minutes
- Correspondence In/Out
- Financial Report
- Members Platform
- AREC Report
- Repeater Trustees Report
- General Business
- Close of Formal Section of Meeting
- Education/Entertainment Segment
- Presentations

Members Present at Meeting

- Alan Dale, Albert & Ria Olivier, David Frith, Paul Kaufmann, Ross Boswell & Gary Ball.

New Members

- None

Visitors

- We had four visitors from Branch 28 (Whangarei)
- Dave ZL1DMA, Brian ZL1BSW, Don ZL1DTE and Peter ZL1TX.

Confirmation/Actions from Previous Minutes

- July Meeting Minutes and Newsletter has been received and accepted as distributed.

Correspondence In

- Newsletters and other electronic correspondence have been forwarded to the members by the Secretary.

Correspondence Out

- Various emails by the Secretary have been sent out, newsletters from other branches.

Financial Report

Finances to 10/08/2019

Cheque Account

Opening Balance \$3,065.27

Subs/Donations \$115.00

Xmas Gifts/Licences -\$127.87

Closing Balance \$3,052.40

Fast Saver Account

Opening Balance \$3,111.43

Interest \$1.54

Closing Balance \$3,112.97

Total Balance \$6,165.37

- Reminder to pay subs (if you haven't already). Also remember that subs have risen this year to \$25
- New subscription category for family/couples. This has been set to \$40.

Members Platform

Anything raised by club members or radio stuff you want to show/tell the club about.

- **Ross – Latest Ali-Express Purchase.** Ross showed off his latest acquisition from Ali-Express, a bag of BFP620's. They are a rather small (understatement) SMD packaged device which was described as "fly shit in a bag" during the meeting! I think we all agreed it was the smallest SMD device we had seen – we wait and see if Ross can solder these things to anything... <https://www.aliexpress.com/item/33023150698.html>
- **Paul Kaufmann – Ozone machine.** Paul showed off his ozone making machine which uses CW code to control the duration of the ozone production cycle. It is controlled via an ATtiny2 (Arduino) and has been housed in an old computer power supply!
- **David – 2m/70cm Dipole.** Although not shown at the meeting, David wrote an article about the construction of his VHF/UHF dipole that was recently emailed to all members.



AREC - Report and Activities

- Nothing reported

Repeater – Trustee's Report and Activities

- The repeater seems to be behaving itself of late after having a bad time in recent months. We will continue to monitor the situation and take follow up action should it go AWOL again.
- While our Thursday 730 Net seems to be low on attendance in general, a recent net we had (15th August) broke the record book – well of recent times anyway, a total of seven checked in. Thanks goes to ZL1ABL, ZL1BDY, ZL1BAA, ZL1PDT, ZL1QV, ZL1PAK who made it an awesome evening!

General Business

Website/Mailing List

- Website continues as normal – check it out regularly, it's one of the clubs primary sources for information and resources <http://zl1rod.org>.

Formal Meeting Closed - 12:10

Next Meeting

The next meeting of the Rodney Amateur Radio Club will commence on,

Saturday 14th September 2019 at 10:00AM

Meeting Room, Wellsford Library

Education/Entertainment

- Alan did not show any videos this time around due to lack of time during the meeting. This is now two months in a row Alan has been unable to show a video. Not Alan's fault at all but just due to lack of time during the meeting because of bad time management of the President!

Things will be back to normal for September. I want to thank Alan for bringing a selection of videos in for us view at our meetings.

Presentations

- Noise Bridge presentation by Brian ZL1BSW and crew from Branch 28

This was an excellent presentation and was enjoyed by all who attended the meeting. Very informative and detailed, leaving me (at least) with some ideas for personal and club projects.

The talk covered SDR devices and the different types available in the marketplace.

Obviously the main area of the talk was aimed at the Chinese made noise bridge and its quality design (NOT). Listed were all it's design faults and the fixes needed to make this a fully functioning device. Also, there was a section woven into the talk about antennas which was very interesting too.

For those that missed the talk, I have found a YouTube video which covers some of what was talked about I regards of measuring return losses in antennas.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=jatYuNvfQyw>

You can find more details on the subjects covered In the July edition of the Branch 28 newsletter "QTC" which, should have been emailed to club members.

Also, we have been kindly given the Powerpoint file of the presentation. We would have emailed this out to members but it is quite large in size and have decided not to so, we will make it downloadable from our clubs website soon.

Some (similar) items shown at the meeting can be found on Ali Express,

Noise Generator - <https://www.aliexpress.com/item/33049371290.html>

Noise Bridge - <https://www.aliexpress.com/item/33014893351.html>

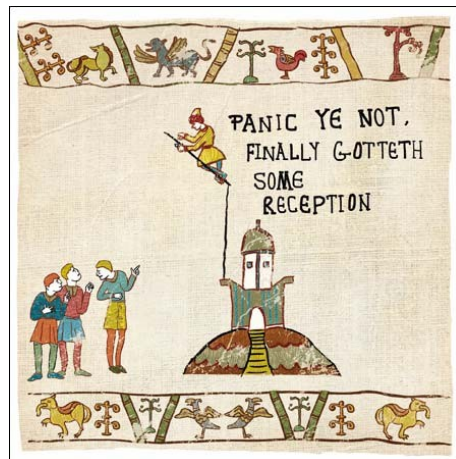
The "expensive" bit shown was the SDRPlay RSP1A - <https://www.sdrplay.com/rsp1a/>

Over and Out

A while ago I informed you via an email from Ross about a tragic event in America where an antenna tower collapsed, killing one person and seriously injuring another. This happened during their attempt to dismantle the tower after detaching the last guying line. Reports suggest that the towers foundations had inadequate drainage and as a result water built up inside the structure and above ground level, slowly rotting the tower legs from inside resulting in failure with a top heavy load (two people) and no guying lines. I have seen quite a few videos on YouTube where they dig a big hole, reinforce the foundations with extra steel and then pour the concrete etc... Little is usually mentioned about drainage for the foundations. If you are planning a fixed/stacking tower then please pay attention to this aspect of the build. If you're unsure about any aspect of installing a tower then I suggest you get good (professional) advice before going ahead with the project.

I thought this months club meeting was great and thoroughly enjoy the presentation given by members of Branch 28 – many thanks guys! I think it has reinforced the fact that we, as a club, need to start ~~playing with toys~~ experimenting as this is part of the enjoyment of our hobby. I will try and put forward a few things that the club could purchase in our upcoming September meeting. If you have any suggestions about what we could buy or, how we should experiment then please express your thoughts and ideas about this. I tend to get little in the way of feedback about this topic.

Radio propagation has been poor in recent months but I have heard the "Triple H" DX Net coming through some evenings on 7.190MHz at 7pm (0700 Z). It might be worth checking out or checking in!



Thank you everyone for supporting the club. Enjoy your radio and radiate that RF!

73 and going QRT...

Gary ZL1FAB

General Information	
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